VANTAGECIRCLE

Buyer's Guide to Employee Engagement Survey Platform

In today's work environment, it's no secret that happy employees are the backbone of any successful business. According to the State of the Global Workplace: 2023 Report, the global economy suffers a staggering $8.8 trillion loss in productivity due to low engagement.

Although annual surveys provide a glimpse into the general sentiment of employees, they cannot sustain continuous engagement and fail to hear employees' voices genuinely.

To do this effectively, companies need a tool that constantly listens to employee feedback and sentiment and identifies issues early to take action upon.

> Salesforce research underscores a crucial insight: Employees are 4.6 times more likely to perform better if they feel their voice is heard.

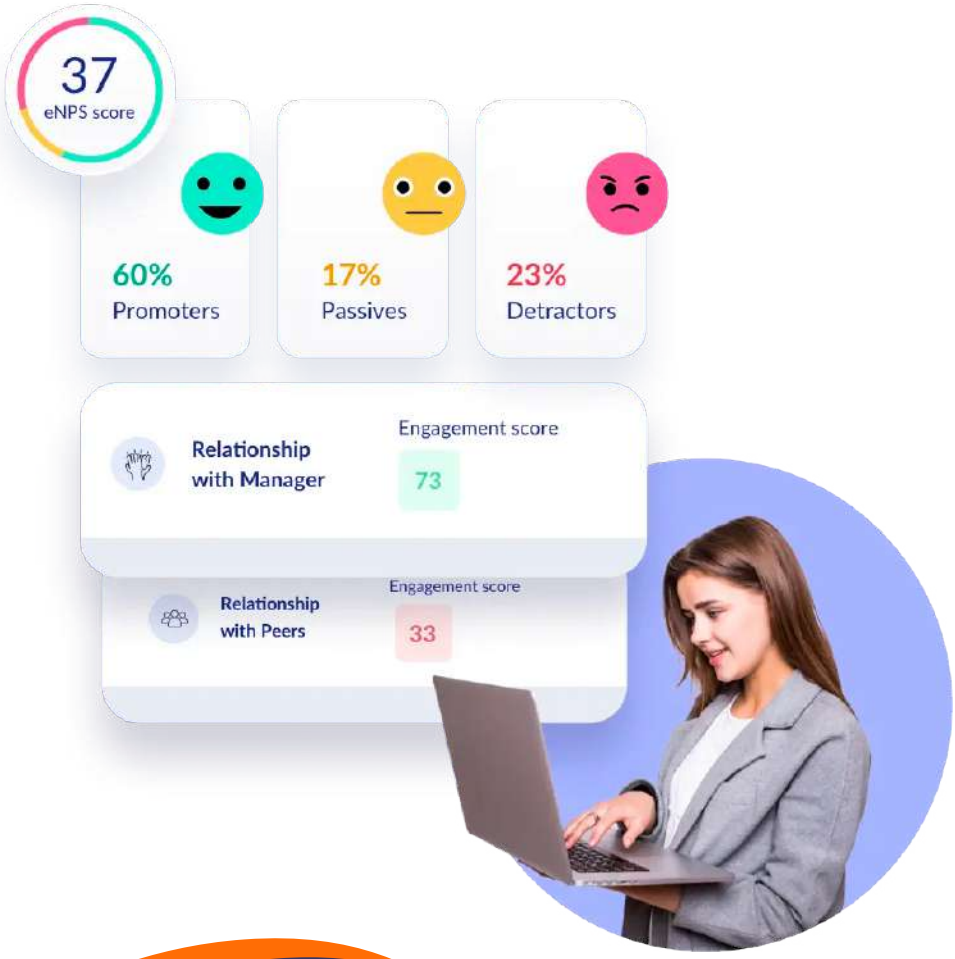
This is where employee engagement surveys come into the picture. Employee engagement surveys provide a real-time snapshot of employee sentiment and enable you to address issues promptly to prevent them from escalating and potentially harming the workplace culture. By integrating pulse surveys into your employee engagement strategy, you're committing to a culture of openness, responsiveness, and continuous improvement.

This Buyer's Guide is crafted specifically for HR administrators and senior management, outlining a streamlined path to selecting the ideal pulse survey solution.

Steps involved in deciding on the right employee survey platform.

Broadly, we have identified 4 basic steps for you to consider when deciding to invest in an employee survey platform.

- Why do you need an employee survey platform?
- Determining your budget and evaluating a cost-benefit analysis
- Comparing different service providers
- Finalizing the purchase



1. Why do you need an employee pulse survey platform?

The primary purpose of pulse surveys is to offer an ongoing, transparent communication channel between employees and management.

Employees who are not engaged or who are actively disengaged cost the world $8.8 trillion in lost productivity, according to Gallup's State of the Global Workplace: 2023 Report. That's equal to 9% of global GDP.

You can assess whether you need an employee survey platform by asking these questions

- What are the main obstacles you encounter in employee communication and gathering feedback effectively?
- What are the primary concerns of your employees, and how do you determine these priorities?
- How do you currently measure employee satisfaction, and how time-intensive is your current approach?
- Do you have mechanisms in place to ensure genuine feedback from all staff members?
- Is anonymous feedback collection feasible within your organization?
- Do you possess tools to easily identify recurring themes and actionable areas from employee feedback?
- How do you evaluate the status of diversity, equity, and inclusion efforts within your organization?

Understanding the responses to these inquiries will assist in pinpointing areas for enhancement within your organization and outlining the steps to present a compelling case for acquiring such a solution for employee engagement.

Key benefits of implementing employee pulse surveys

1. **Promote a Culture of Continuous Feedback:** You can establish an organizational culture where feedback is not only encouraged but is a critical component of everyday operations, leading to ongoing improvements and innovations.

2. **Address Issues Promptly and Retain Top Talent:** With their agile responses, employee engagement surveys allow leadership to take swift action to mitigate issues before they escalate. This in turn helps in retaining top talent.

3. **Benchmark and Track Progress:** You can set benchmarks for engagement and track progress over time, offering clear insights into the effectiveness of initiatives and strategies.

4. **Support Informed Decision-Making:** The analytics and data provided by employee engagement surveys equip you with the information needed to make strategic decisions that align with employee needs and organizational goals.

5. **Enhance Employee Engagement:** By regularly soliciting feedback, employees feel heard and valued, which directly impacts their engagement and satisfaction levels.

Summarizing employee pulse surveys effectively enables you to -

Listen

Employee survey software facilitates active engagement throughout the entire employee journey.

Analyze

Contemporary survey tools leverage sophisticated data analytics to pinpoint patterns, insights, and critical areas of focus for organizations, sparing HR professionals from manual data collection and spreadsheet analysis

Act

Leading survey platforms enable organizational leaders to enhance performance through actionable insights and recommendations generated by machine learning after analyzing survey data and identifying significant trends.

2. Determining your budget and evaluating cost-benefit analysis

A critical step in implementing an employee survey solution is establishing a budget that reflects the organization's financial considerations and the strategic value of an employee feedback mechanism.

You can start by evaluating the pointers below:

- Assess Initial Costs vs. Long-term Benefits: Consider both the initial cost of investing in employee survey platform and the long-term benefits of improved employee engagement. The value derived from a motivated workforce often outweighs the upfront investment.
- Factor in Efficiency Gains: Assess whether you are saving time and resources compared to manual methods or less sophisticated tools. These efficiency gains should be considered when budgeting.
- Evaluate the Impact on Employee Retention: High employee turnover is costly. By investing in employee survey platforms you can improve retention, avoiding the costs associated with recruiting and training new hires.
- ROI Calculation: Calculate the potential ROI from investing in employee engaged survey platforms by considering factors such as top talent retention, reduced absenteeism and increased employee productivity resulting from a more engaged workforce.

By evaluating the cost vs benefit, you can arrive at a budget which would justify the investment against the ROI achieved from a positive organizational change.

Let us see how different studies have highlighted value propositions from employee engagement surveys

54% According to Randstand 2023 Workmonitor, 54% of workers state that they would quit their job if they didn't feel a sense of belonging.

43% 43% of employees who identify as being highly engaged receive feedback at least once a week. (Forbes)

91% When employers request feedback, new hires are 91% more likely to commit to the employer relationship, which is key to reducing 90-day turnover. (The Talent Board)

41% According to a recent study by Gallup, businesses with high levels of employee engagement achieve up to 41% lower turnover rates.

Did You Know:

Google has also benefited from switching to peer-based reviews. Peers, senior managers, and junior coworkers at Google are invited to participate in evaluations, with all feedback carrying the same weight. The collated information is discussed during regular meetings, annual performance summaries, and professional development reviews. After simplifying their scale and survey questions, they noticed:

- *An improvement of 25% less time preparing feedback. (HBR)*
- *An increase from 49% to 75% of employees found the feedback system useful. (HBR)*

3. Comparing different service providers

After the initial considerations, it's time to choose the vendor who provides the most value without overshooting your budget. To help you in the process, we have designed a set of questions that you can ask the vendors you have shortlisted.

To understand the full expense of purchasing from a vendor, consider the below questions

- Is the pricing of the platform determined by the quantity of surveys, users, or responses?
- Are there any fees associated with setup or implementation?
- Are there any extra expenses for support, maintenance, or upgrades?
- Are there any charges for canceling or terminating the service?

After considering the costs you may ask the vendor some other questions pertinent to the platform. You consider the below or add some of your own

- Is there a cap on the number of administrators who can access dashboards?
- Does the agreement specify a contract duration?
- Is there a restriction on the number of surveys during your contract period?

The final set of questions should be based on the platform's effectiveness to justify the ROI

- What amount of your resource's billing time will be required to manage this platform effectively?
- What approach should you consider for gauging the return on investment for this soft ware?
- Is the software capable of pinpointing areas for enhancement within our organization or leadership team, and facilitating the development of action plans to tackle them?
- Are there any guarantees offered by the vendor?

A comparative analysis of the responses given by the different vendors can help you reach an informed decision.

4. Finalizing the purchase

Now that the time has come for you to select the vendor, consider these final set of questions and see how which vendor makes it to your final selection

- How intuitive and user-friendly is the software for both survey administrators and respondents?
- Does the software have the capability to integrate with other software systems or HRIS?
- Do your platform support language translations to accommodate global teams?
- Are there permission features in place that regulate access within the platform?
- What metrics does the software track and provide reports on?
- How does the platform handle quantitative data from survey responses, and does it offer insights from qualitative employee comments?
- What types of surveys can be conducted using the software, such as engagement surveys, pulse surveys, wellbeing surveys, or annual surveys?
- Are there restrictions on the number of surveys that can be conducted?
- To what extent can surveys be customized? Can we add or modify questions and response options tailored to our organization? Are there any pre-made templates.
- Is it possible for respondents to submit surveys anonymously?
- Can responses to employee comments be handled anonymously?
- Does the software offer real-time reporting and analytics? What kinds of reports are accessible?
- Is it possible to export insights from the software, and if so, how?
- What segmentation options are available for data?
- Can the system provide recommendations for improvement or training based on data analysis?
- How customizable are the surveys? Can we add or modify questions and response options unique to our organization?

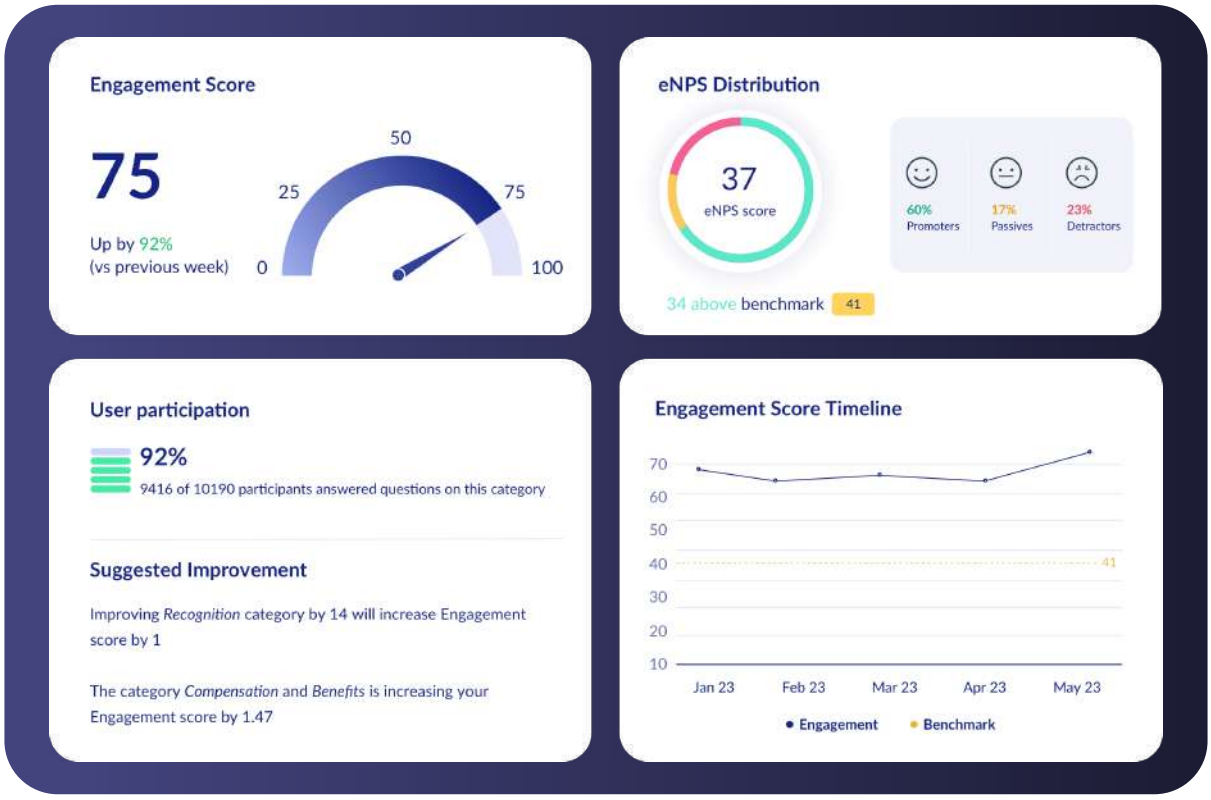
It's worth considering that a single vendor might not be equipped to fulfill all the mentioned requirements. Therefore, it's recommended to select the vendor that aligns best with your objectives and offers the most cost-effective solution.

Are you already using Employee Engagement Surveys?

Check if your service provider offers you these features*

Does your platform provide incentivizing survey participants?	YES	NO
Does your platform provide employee experience / lifecycle cycle?	YES	NO
Does your platform provide kiosk mode survey?	YES	NO
Does your platform provide comparative / periodic analysis?	YES	NO
Does your platform provide sentiment analysis?	YES	NO
Does your platform provide action planning?	YES	NO
Does your platform provide customizable survey templates?	YES	NO
Does your platform allow for conducting surveys at various frequencies (daily, weekly etc)?	YES	NO
Are you facing technical issues with your current platform?	YES	NO

*If you find yourself without any of these essential advantages – Vantage Pulse has you covered.



Vantage Pulse : Employee Survey Tool

Vantage Pulse stands out in the landscape of employee survey solutions for its distinctive attributes and advantages, making it your preferred choice. Designed with the end-user in mind, Vantage Pulse offers an engaging and straightforward interface that encourages high participation rates, ensuring a broad spectrum of employee voices are heard.

Here are the key reasons why Vantage Pulse can be the solution your organization needs:

Comprehensive Dashboard:

A dashboard that showcases engagement score, user participation, eNPS scores and identifies top and bottom scorers, and offers a segment-wise analysis. It's designed to give a quick and clear overview of survey results

Pre-built templates and Survey Customization:

Pre-built templates and Survey Customization: Choose from our comprehensive library of 25+ survey templates. Further customize every aspect of your pulse surveys to fit the unique culture and needs of your organization.

Employee Experience Survey:

Explore key stages and touchpoints in an employee's journey with the organization, including onboarding, initial development, ongoing development & retention, and separation

Seamless Integration and Language Support:

Effortlessly integrate Vantage Pulse with your existing HR technologies and get upto 14+ different language support to run surveys in your preferred language.

Simple Survey Creation Tool:

A user-friendly interface for creating surveys without compromising on features which you can learn in a matter of hours.

Anonymous survey:

Collect and respond to your employee's feedback anonymously ensuring an unbiased review system fostering a stronger and transparent connection between employees and managers.

Advanced Real-Time Analytics:

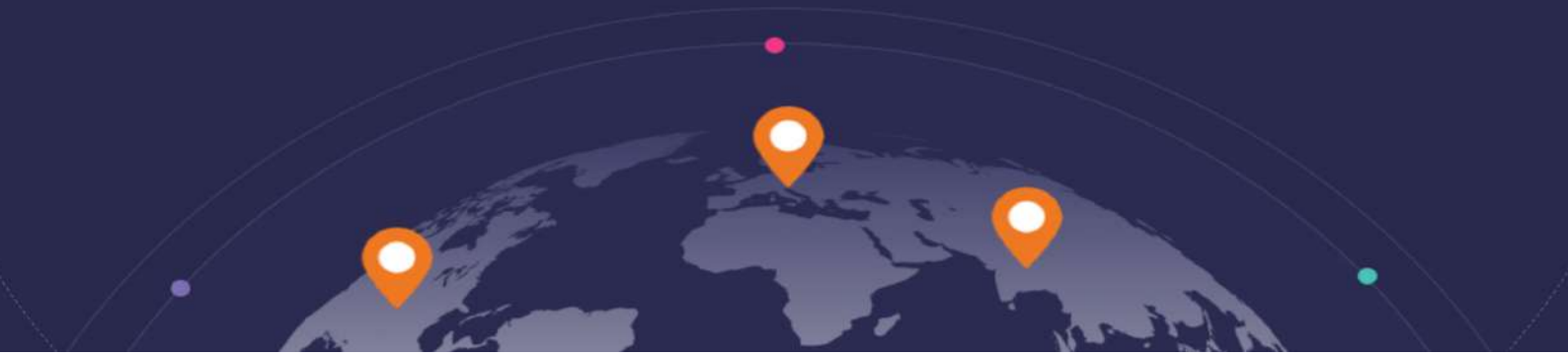
Leverage cutting-edge analytics to transform survey data into actionable insights. Vantage Pulse provides real-time feedback analysis, enabling swift and informed decision-making.

Dedicated Support and Resources:

Benefit from Vantage Pulse's unparalleled customer support and access to an extensive library of resources, including best practices, guides, and templates, to optimize your pulse survey initiatives.

Our Global Capabilities

100+	10K+	16+	700+	2M+
Countries	Rewards Option	Global Languages	Clients	Users



If you are interested in exploring our advanced employee survey software further

Book a demo

G2 Rating	Capterra	GetApp
4.7	4.7	4.7
4,300+ Reviews	5,200+ Reviews	5,000+ Reviews

Contact Information:

For more information, to schedule a demo, or to speak with a Vantage Pulse expert, reach out to us at: -
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www.vantagecircle.com